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Overview

This course has been designed for Authorised Officer (AO) candidates wanting to perform inspections of woodchips for export.

Prior to undertaking inspections of woodchips for export, you must be appropriately trained, deemed competent and appointed by the Department of Agriculture, Water and the Environment for the job function FOP3001: Export inspection of woodchips.

This job function covers three different inspection techniques: packaged product, bulk product into containers and bulk product into vessels. You can choose to be trained in either a single technique or a combination. More information is available in the Reference: Table of authorised officer job functions within the [Plant Export Operations Manual](#).

The learning and assessment methods for this course include:

- eLearning
- Mandatory facilitated training
- Competency based assessment.

Learning Outcomes

A working knowledge of export inspection requirements, procedures and techniques is fundamental for AOs carrying out this job function.

This course provides you with the knowledge and skills to effectively:

- conduct, document and record inspections of woodchips for export
- comply with legislation, organisational and industry standards
- understand the hazards and risks involved in the inspection of woodchips, in regards to work health and safety and the environment
- understand your role and responsibilities as an AO, in performing inspections of woodchips for export.

Course Requirements

eLearning (Approximately 6.25 hours)

The eLearning has been designed to give candidates a broad overview of plant exports, prior to commencing the mandatory facilitated training.

Completing the eLearning prior to commencing facilitated training is recommended, as it allows candidates to focus on applying their knowledge and conceptual understanding of the eLearning to ‘real-world’ problems and scenarios covered during the facilitated training.

The eLearning includes:

- Plant export essentials—an introduction to plants and plant product exports, plant export legislation, work health and safety, communication, making good decisions, export treatments, and importing country requirements (approximately 5.5 hours).
- Conducting phytosanitary inspections of forest products for export (woodchips, logs and processed forest products)—pre-inspection, inspection, and how to pass or reject the consignment (approximately 45 minutes).

Note: If you have successfully completed the plant export essentials and / or forest products modules through eLearning for another job function, you will not be required to repeat these modules.

Mandatory facilitated training (Approximately 6 hours)

After enrolling in the eLearning, you are required to participate in facilitated training delivered by a department Plant Export Assessor (PEA) to further develop your skills and knowledge.

The combination of the eLearning, instructional material published on the [Plant Export Operations Manual](#) and facilitated training will develop your understanding of your role and responsibilities as an AO when performing this job function.

Competency based assessment (Approximately an initial 2.5 hours, then 30 minutes per additional technique).

After completing the eLearning and facilitated training, you are required to demonstrate your competency to a PEA, through an assessment.

Refer to the FOP3001 Competency and Assessment Requirements document for more detailed information about the assessment and competency requirements for this job function.

Download

Document	Pages	File size
FOP3001 Competency and Assessment Requirements PDF 	6	251 KB
FOP3001 Competency and Assessment Requirements DOCX 	6	140 KB

If you have difficulty accessing these files, please visit [web accessibility](#).

Ongoing

Following successful completion of the course, and being deemed competent by a PEA, you must:

- maintain ongoing competency

- carry out this job function in line with the relevant policies and procedures
- be audited by the department
- participate in additional training and assessment as required.

Pre-requisites

This job function has no pre-requisites to enrolment, however you may require a Marine Security Identification Card (MSIC) if inspections take place at a wharf.

Qualification

On successful completion of the course, you will receive an Instrument of Appointment accrediting you in the job function FOP3001: Export inspection of woodchips—for the inspection techniques for which you have been trained—permitting you to inspect woodchips for export, on behalf of the department.

Course Duration

This course is flexible and the duration varies significantly from person to person. The duration of each course requirement (outlined under Course Requirements) is a guide only and you are encouraged to only nominate for an assessment when you determine you are ready.

Location

- eLearning – online
- Mandatory facilitated training – will take place at a location of the candidate's choosing, in consultation with a Plant Export Assessor
- Competency based assessment – will take place at an export registered establishment, registered for packing/inspection forest products, to be arranged by the candidate.

Commencement Date

You can commence the eLearning once you have been enrolled in it, however facilitated training will take place at a date arranged by the candidate and the department, depending on demand.

Cost

Fees and charges apply to becoming an AO and maintaining your AO appointment. Further information about AO [fees and charges](#) is available on the department's website.

Further Information

Related Courses

Note: Candidates are not required to complete these courses to become appointed in the FOP3001 job function.

Source: <https://www.agriculture.gov.au/biosecurity-trade/export/controlled-goods/plants-plant-products/ao/job-functions/export-inspection-woodchips>